VIT-AP UNIVERSITY

VIT-AP/2026/COE/MP/1 18-08-2026

CIRCULAR

Sub.: Guidelines for the Award of Punishment and Penalty to Examination Malpractice and Unfair Means Cases

The University is committed to ensuring fairness, transparency, confidentiality, and integrity in its examination and assessment system. To ensure uniformity and consistency in dealing with cases of examination malpractice and unfair means, the University has decided to standardise the punishments and penalties applicable to malpractice cases reported during all examinations and assessments conducted by the University, with effect from the Academic Year 2026–27 onwards including the ongoing Fall Semester (2026-27).

(I) Action against students who indulge in examination malpractice in CAT

S. No.	Nature of Malpractice	Actions
1.	Use/ Possession of written/printed/photocopied materials in the form of chits, notes, calculator covers, pouches, data books, exam pads, or information related to the examination in any form (digital or hard copy), including on the student's body, clothing, or other wear.	**ALL# theory courses of respective CAT will be awarded "ZERO"**
2.	Use/Possession of electronic devices either in switched ON or OFF condition of any form, including mobile phones, smart watches, wireless headsets, programmable calculator, other transmitting or receiving devices with or without subject related materials or any other electronic/digital means of communication in the examination hall.	**ALL# theory courses of respective CAT will be awarded "ZERO"**
3	Use of electronic devices such as hidden earpieces, smart watches, smart glasses, and smartphones to access unauthorized materials (internet resources, AI tools, etc.) or communicate with others during exams for obtaining or facilitating unauthorized assistance in the examination.	**ALL# theory courses of respective CAT will be awarded "ZERO" along with a penalty of Rs. 10,000/-**
4	A student who is not appearing for the examination is found to be assisting or facilitating another student appearing for the examination, from outside the examination hall, by communicating, transmitting, or sharing answers or other unauthorized examination-related information.	**ALL# theory courses of respective CAT will be awarded "ZERO" along with a penalty of Rs. 10,000/-**
5.	Copying or attempting to copy subject-related content from a desk, nearby wall or other unauthorized location.	**ALL# theory courses of respective CAT will be awarded "ZERO"**
6	Possession of photocopied reference material not authorized by the Controller of Examinations or competent authority during open notebook examination, or possession of loose sheets during open-notebook/open-book examination.	**PARTICULAR course will be awarded ZERO**
7.	Student taking answer script (used or unused) out of examination hall	**PARTICULAR course will be awarded ZERO**
8.	Copying or attempting to copy the content of other students or exchanging / displaying the written content through a question Paper, Answer sheets, or other means.	**PARTICULAR course will be awarded ZERO**

9.	Talking / communicating in any manner with other students during the examination, including through gestures, signals, etc. to solicit or provide unauthorized assistance	**PARTICULAR course will be awarded ZERO**
10.	Possession of unauthorized written/photocopied/printed material of the nature specified in S. No. 1, which is not relevant to that examination	**PARTICULAR course will be awarded ZERO**
11.	Intimidation, threatening behavior, abusive or serious misconduct, assault, or attempted assault against an invigilator, examiner, University official, or fellow student, whether inside or outside the examination hall, in connection with the conduct of the examination	**PARTICULAR course will be awarded ZERO, along with immediate interim suspension pending disciplinary enquiry**
12.	Involvement of any kind of malpractice in the continuous assessment LAB	**ALL the LAB courses will be awarded "ZERO" including embedded labs registered in the semester**
13.	Writing an answer relevant to the exam on the question paper or making use of the question paper for rough work and not communicating with others.	**a penalty of Rs. 3,000**
14.	Making an appeal/request in the answer script coupled with or without an offer or promise of any form of consideration and/or writing register number or name in an unauthorized manner in the answer sheets.	**a penalty of Rs. 3,000**
15.	Wearing or using another student's ID card during the exam	**a penalty of Rs. 3,000**
16.	Repeated involvement in malpractices covered under S. Nos. 1 to 5, whether in the same semester or subsequent semesters.	**ALL# theory courses of respective CAT will be awarded "ZERO" along with one semester suspension**
17.	Repeated involvement in malpractices covered under S. Nos. 6 to 11, whether in the same semester or subsequent semesters.	**ALL# theory courses of respective CAT will be awarded "ZERO" along with one semester suspension**
18.	Unauthorized access to examination question paper and/or other confidential information related to examination, or attempt to do so in any manner	**ALL# the theory and LAB courses will be awarded ZERO, along with immediate interim suspension pending disciplinary enquiry**
19.	Cases of impersonation	**ALL# theory courses of respective CAT will be awarded "ZERO" along with one semester suspension**

- Excluding Industrial internship, projects, comprehensive viva, ECA Courses and online (MOOC) courses registered in the semester. **ALL** represent only for the specific semester (Regular (Fall/Winter) or Summer).

Note: Malpractice and its action from S. No. 1 to 19 is also applicable for in-campus online courses and soft skills courses.

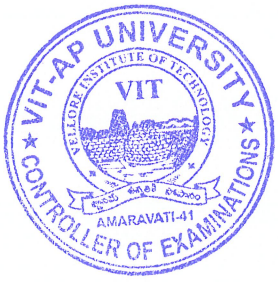
(II) Action against students who indulge in examination malpractice in FAT

S. No.	Nature of Malpractice	Actions
1.	Use/ Possession of written/printed/photocopied materials in the form of chits, notes, calculator covers, pouches, data books, exam pads, or information related to the examination in any form (digital or hard copy), including on the student's body, clothing, or other wear.	**ALL# theory and lab courses registered in the semester will be awarded "ZERO"**
2.	Use/Possession of electronic devices either in switched ON or OFF condition of any form, including mobile phones, smart watches, wireless headsets, programmable calculator, other transmitting or receiving devices with or without subject related materials or any other electronic/digital means of communication in the examination hall.	**ALL# theory and lab courses registered in the semester will be awarded "ZERO"**
3.	Use of electronic devices such as hidden earpieces, smart watches, smart glasses, and smartphones to access unauthorized materials (internet resources, AI tools, etc.) or communicate with others during exams for obtaining or facilitating unauthorized assistance in the examination.	**ALL# theory and lab courses registered in the semester will be awarded "ZERO" along with one semester suspension**
4	A student who is not appearing for the examination is found to be assisting or facilitating another student appearing for the examination, from outside the examination hall, by communicating, transmitting, or sharing answers or other unauthorized examination-related information.	**ALL# theory and lab courses registered in the semester will be awarded "ZERO" along with one semester suspension**
5.	Copying or attempting to copy subject-related content from a desk, nearby wall or other unauthorized location.	**ALL# theory and lab courses registered in the semester will be awarded "ZERO"**
6	Possession of photocopied reference material not authorized by the Controller of Examinations or competent authority during open notebook examination, or possession of loose sheets during open-notebook/open-book examination.	**PARTICULAR course will be awarded ZERO**
7.	Student taking answer script (used or unused) out of examination hall	**PARTICULAR course will be awarded ZERO**
8.	Copying or attempting to copy the content of other students or exchanging / displaying the written content through a question Paper, Answer sheets, or other means.	**PARTICULAR course will be awarded ZERO**
9.	Talking / communicating in any manner with other students during the examination, including through gestures, signals, etc. to solicit or provide unauthorized assistance	**PARTICULAR course will be awarded ZERO**
10.	Possession of unauthorized written/photocopied/printed material of the nature specified in S. No. 1, which is not relevant to that examination	**PARTICULAR course will be awarded ZERO**
11.	Intimidation, threatening behavior, abusive or serious misconduct, assault, or attempted assault against an invigilator, examiner, University official, or fellow student, whether inside or outside the examination hall, in connection with the conduct of the examination	**PARTICULAR course will be awarded ZERO, along with immediate interim suspension pending disciplinary enquiry**
12.	Involvement of any kind of malpractice in LAB FAT	**ALL the LAB courses will be awarded "ZERO" including embedded labs registered in the semester**

13.	Writing an answer relevant to the exam on the question paper or making use of the question paper for rough work and not communicating with others.	**a penalty of Rs. 3,000**
14.	Making an appeal/request in the answer script coupled with or without an offer or promise of any form of consideration and/or writing register number or name in an unauthorized manner in the answer sheets.	**a penalty of Rs. 3,000**
15.	Wearing or using another student's ID card during the exam	**a penalty of Rs. 3,000**
16.	Repeated involvement in malpractices covered under S. Nos. 1, 2, 5, and 12, whether in the same semester or subsequent semesters.	**ALL# theory and lab courses registered in the semester will be awarded "ZERO" along with one semester suspension**
17.	Repeated involvement in malpractices covered under S. Nos. 6 to 11, whether in the same semester or subsequent semesters.	**ALL# theory and lab courses registered in the semester will be awarded "ZERO" along with one semester suspension**
18.	Unauthorized access to examination question paper and/or other confidential information related to examination, or attempt to do so in any manner	**ALL# the theory and LAB courses in the semester will be awarded ZERO, along with immediate interim suspension pending disciplinary enquiry**
19.	Cases of impersonation	**ALL# theory and lab courses registered in the semester will be awarded "ZERO" along with one semester suspension**

- Excluding Industrial internship, projects, comprehensive viva, ECA Courses and online (MOOC) courses registered in the semester. ALL represent only for the specific semester (Regular (Fall/Winter) or Summer).

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18/08/2026

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